A SIDE STORY FROM LEFT FIELD

STAY BY MY SIDE.

CHISA...

PLEASE...

...NO.

NO WAY...

FWUMP

ガクッ

NOT HAP-PENING.

GIVE IT UP.

I WON'T ASK YOU TO DO ANYTHING!

CLATR

カタン

FWIP

JUST BEING NEAR YOU IS ALL I NEED!

Midterms season at Izu University.

...HMPH.

ALL YOU HAVE TO DO IS SIT NEXT TO ME AND SHOW ME YOUR ANSWERS!

Side Story: Idiots, Tests, and Cheating

WHAT NOW? WE'RE ALL GOING TO FLUNK AT THIS RATE.

I SEE...

I'M SORRY. NEGOTI-ATIONS FAILED.

IT'D BE ROUGH TO FAIL THE SECOND-LANG* CLASS.

*Short for Secondary Foreign Language (other than English).

CHEATING ON OUR OWN, HUH?

SHOULD HAVE KNOWN.

GUESS THAT'S OUR ONLY OP-TION.

WE'LL PUSH THE LIMIT OF HOW SMALL WE CAN MAKE OUR CHEAT SHEETS!

DON'T TELL ME YOU PLAN TO START STUDYING NOW.

WE'LL JUST HAVE TO FIGURE SOMETHING OUT.

THERE'S NOT ENOUGH TIME BEFORE THE EXAM.

WHY AM I A MAGNET FOR THESE KINDS OF LOSERS?

ME, TOO.

LET ME IN ON IT.

YOU GUYS CHEATING, KITAHARA?

BIRDS OF A FEATHER FLOCK TO-GETHER.

ウィーン VWEEE

GOOD QUES-TION...

SO, HOW DO WE SNEAK THEM IN?

IT'S DEFINITELY SMALLER, BUT...

THIS IS THE SMALLEST SIZE WE CAN STILL READ.

THE QUES-TION IS, HOW DO WE HIDE THEM?

Method 3: inside a towel.

Method 2: Inside a drink label.

Method 1: inside the pencil case.

THAT'S RISKY.

WAN-NAI, HUH?

WHAT'RE YOU GONNA DO, NOJI-MA?

I'M GOING WITH THE WAN-NAI METHOD.

PUSH

Wan-nai: Taken from the English "one night", it means to cram for a test the night before.

"inner arm".

However, when written with kanji, it becomes...

WE MUST PERSEVERE UNTIL THE END AND PASS TOGETHER FOR SURE!

OORAH!

YOU ALL KNOW HOW IMPORTANT SECONDARY FOREIGN LANGUAGE CREDITS ARE, RIGHT?

YES.

BUT OF COURSE.

I'M STICKING MINE TO THE BACK OF THIS FAN.

FLIP

WHAT ABOUT YOU, KITA-HARA?

ME, TOO.

THEN I'LL STICK MINE TO MY CLOTHES.

The day of the secondary foreign language (German) exam.

Midterm
First Period
German
1:00~2:00

ゴクッ
GULP

ALL RIGHT...

PUT YOUR PENCIL CASES AWAY, PLEASE.

FOOD AND DRINKS ARE ALSO PROHIBIT-ED DURING THE TEST.

PLEASE PUT AWAY YOUR DRINKS.

HMM? SHOULD I?

YOU MIGHT HAVE TO MAKE IT WORTH MY WHI-

H-HEY, HELP ME OUT HERE.

フラッシュ FLASH

フラッシュ FLASH

WHY DIDN'T YOU SEE THIS COMING?

DO, HO, HO. YOU FOOL.

BUT, MAN, THIS TEST ...

YOU'RE ON YOUR OWN.

DON'T LOOK AT US LIKE THAT.

ピッ FWIP

THE TEST WILL BEGIN AT ONE O'CLOCK. YOU'RE FREE TO LEAVE WHEN YOU'RE FINISHED.

TIK TIK

BEGIN.

TIK カチッ

WHY DO THOSE GUYS LOOK SO CALM?!

I DON'T UNDER-STAND A SINGLE WORD.

DON'T TELL ME THEY ACTU-ALLY THINK THEY'LL PASS!

THOSE ARE THE SMILES OF MEN WHO HAVE ACCEPTED THEIR FATE!

THEY KNOW WHEN TO QUIT!

WE'LL BE LEAVING NOW.

ガタタッ CLATR

GUH...

HM?

THUD ドサッ

...

WHERE'S SHIMOKAWA, ANYWAY?

PROBABLY SKIPPED?

下川くん

SHIMO-KAWA-KUN

AH...

MY SWEAT BLURRED THE INK AND I CAN'T READ ANYTHING!

IDIOT...

THAT'S WHY I SAID WAN-NAI IS RISKY.

ぐっしょり SOAKED

カチャ チェック

From Shimokawa
Sub: Gonna study
Body: Tell me what's on the German exam.

HM?

ウィーン ブルルル

Midterm
First Period
German
1:00-2:00

...

NOTH-ING. JUST ANOTHER CASUALTY.

???

WHAT'S UP, KITA-HARA?

...

Sub: RE: Gonna study
It's okay. You don't need to anymore.

カチカチ TAK TAK

コチ TOK

カチ TIK

12 3 6 9

コチ TOK

カチ TIK

EVEN WITH THE CHEAT SHEETS, I CAN BARELY SOLVE ANY OF THEM...

LEAVE IT TO ME.

TEAM-WORK, HUH?

カツ CLAK

カツ CLAK

カツ CLAK

LOOKS LIKE WE'LL NEED TO WORK TO-GETHER.

!!!

HM?

WHISK

ペラ FWIP

ペラ FWIP

ペラ FWIP

...IS THE MEANING OF THIS?

ゴゴゴゴ

AND WHAT ...

ゴゴゴ

WHAT HAP-PENED TO TEAM-WORK ?!

FWIP

...

おーおおおっ

OH, WELL. I SUPPOSE I'LL GIVE YOU SOME FREEBIES.

THESE COME STRAIGHT FROM MY LECTURES.

TRANSLATE THE FOL-LOWING TO GERMAN AND WRITE THEM ON THE BACK OF YOUR TEST.

THE QUES-TIONS ARE TOO DAMN HARD!

HMM?

ん!?

I EXPECT-ED MORE FROM YOU ALL.

FAIL

RHEU-
MATIC
HEART
DISEASE.

SOMEONE TELL HIM WHAT A FREEBIE IS!

HOW THE HELL SHOULD WE KNOW?!

QUES-
TION
ONE.

A NAKED MAN HOLDING A BANANA.

QUES-
TION
TWO.

WAS THAT REALLY A GERMAN LECTURE?!

WHAT WAS HE TALKING ABOUT DURING CLASS?!

LAST
QUES-
TION.

JAMES THOMAS.

SCREW THIS!

AN ENGLISH ONE, AT THAT!

THAT'S A GOD-DAMN NAME!

Later

ATTENTION, EVERYONE. EXAM SCORES THIS TIME WERE ATROCIOUS.

I HAVE TO MAKE THIS UP SOMEHOW.

FAILURE CONFIRMED.

THIS IS BAD...

SERIOUSLY?!

"!!" CHATTER!!!

AS SUCH, A SCORE OF 10 OR MORE IS CONSIDERED A PASSING GRADE.

20 AND OVER IS CONSIDERED A B.

*See back.

...HM?

YOU CAN SAY THAT AGAIN.

NO KIDDING! WERE SAVED!

ALL RIGHT! I CAN'T BELIEVE WE MADE IT!

I have suspicions of students cheating, so there will be a retest.

See me later.

ペラッ
FLIP

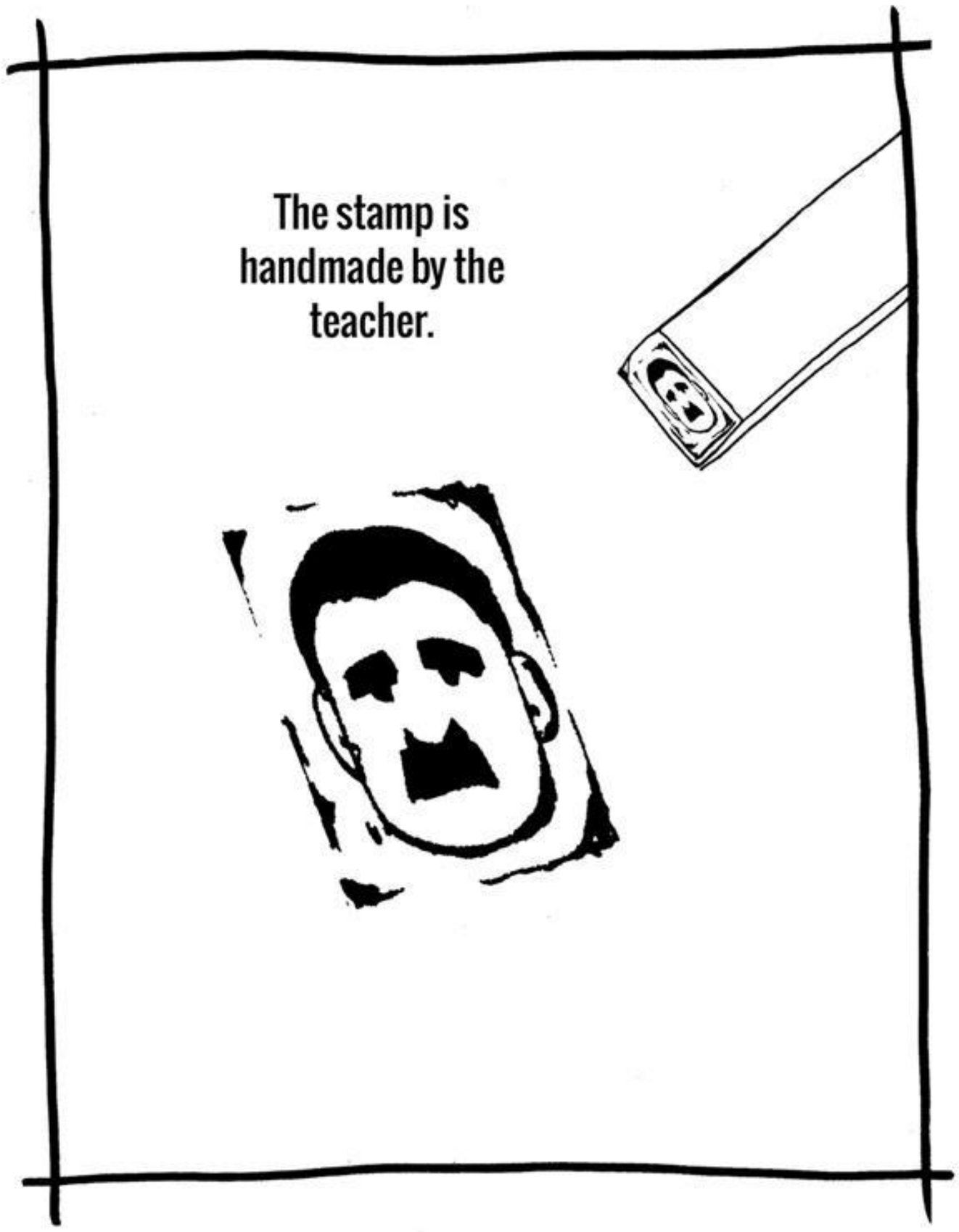
THOSE IDIOTS ARE AT IT AGAIN.

FUUUUCK!

SHRRRT

This is a manga about diving.

Side Story / End


The stamp is handmade by the teacher.

Grand Blue Dreaming

EXTRA ESSAY

First Diving Experience

I WENT DIVING FOR THE FIRST TIME IN IZU AS A REFER-ENCE!

SEEING AS THIS IS MY FIRST DIVING MANGA,

Iori

Substitute

NICE TO MEET YOU! THIS IS KIMITAKE YOSHIOKA, THE ARTIST OF GRAND BLUE.

FIRST, WE TOOK A SHORT TRAINING COURSE AT THE DIVING SHOP.

Instructor

DON'T WORRY. DIVING AND SWIMMING ARE COM-PLETELY DIFFERENT.

UMM. I CAN'T SWIM. LIKE, NOT AT ALL.

WITH ME WAS THE WRITER, KENJI INOUE-SENSEI, AS WELL AS OUR EDITOR.

I'M GOING TO SINK...

I REALLY CAN'T SWIM AT ALL.

TRUTH BE TOLD, I'VE ACTUAL-LY BEEN AFRAID OF THE OCEAN EVER SINCE SECOND GRADE.

Ed

YOU'LL BE FINE.

C-CAN I HAVE A SMOKE?

Ed

MEAN-WHILE, OUR EDITOR AND FELLOW BEGINNER STARTED GETTING COLD FEET.

ガタ CLATR

?!

BUT HE SAID HE GOES SWIM-MING ALL THE TIME.

THANKFULLY, THE LESSON WAS VERY EASY TO UN-DERSTAND,

AND I GRADUALLY STARTED TO LOOSEN UP.

TO CLEAR YOUR EARS, PINCH YOUR NOSE LIKE THIS AND...

BEFOREHAND, INOUE-SENSEI (DEMON) TOLD ME NOT TO DO ANY RESEARCH IN ADVANCE BECAUSE HE, "WANTED TO SEE A BEGINNER'S GENUINE REAC-TION," SO I ENDED UP LEARNING COMPLETELY FROM SCRATCH.

Ino

Ed

READY TO GET START-ED?

So little stamina he's already out of breath.

THE OCEAN!

THE OCEAN!

HUFF

HUFF

Ed

Ino

AFTER PUTTING ON OUR SUITS, WE FINALLY HEADED OUT TO SEA!

WHOA!

WHOOSH

YOU CAN TELL?

THE WATER'S SALTY AROUND HERE.

APPARENTLY, THE OCEAN TASTES DIFFERENT DEPENDING ON WHERE YOU ARE.

FISH!

SQUID!

SINCE IT WAS ONLY AN INTRODUCTION, WE DIDN'T DIVE VERY DEEP, BUT IT ENDED UP BEING A GREAT EXPERIENCE.

Just learned.

BCDS ARE AWE-SOME!

AND I'M NOT SINK-ING!

THE TANK FEELS SO LIGHT!

OOH!

Hang on to the rope, please!

SWISH

SWOSH

OOF!

FWUMP

...AND WAS REMINDED HOW HEAVY THE TANK WAS AFTER GETTING BACK TO LAND.

NOD

I MANAGED TO CLEAR MY EARS UNDER-WATER...

DIVING ISN'T SCARY AT ALL!

I'D LIKE TO GO AGAIN SOME-TIME.

See ya.

THANKS TO EVERY-ONE FOR HELPING ME GATHER MATERIAL.

Learning how to clean up.

THAT WAS AW-SOME!

AWE-SOME!

I WAS SO EXCITED THAT ALL I COULD SAY WAS, "THAT WAS AWE-SOME!"

SPSH

SPSH

Ino

Ed

The End

TO THE MIXER, AWAY.

Grand Blue Dreaming

VOL 3

Grand Blue Dreaming 2

KODANSHA COMICS Digital Edition

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First published in Japan in 2007by Kodansha Ltd., Tokyo.
Electronic Publishing rights for this English edition arranged through Kodansha Ltd., Tokyo.

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English digital edition published by Kodansha Advanced Media, LLC, San Francisco.

www.kodanshacomics.com

ISBN: 9781682338957

Digital Edition: 1.0.0

Translation by Adam Hirsch
Lettering by Jan Lan Ivan Concepcion
Editing by Sarah Tilson
YKS Services LLC/SKY Japan, INC.